LayerSync
AI Systems & Digital Transformation

BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT · SYNC ESTATE

Sync Finance v1

Real estate finance, from receipt book to statement

Requirements for the build team to map Sync Finance v1: trust money, landlord payouts, commission, stand instalments and the statements that prove it. Kept deliberately simple, to replace Excel and manual receipt books first, then iterate.

Prepared by LayerSync · 16 October 2026 · Internal · Draft for team review

01 Purpose

Sync Finance v1 gives a real estate agency one correct record of client money and agency income, so it can stop using receipt books and Excel, and produce landlord, tenant and agent statements in minutes instead of days.

The problem today

- Payments are written in manual receipt books, then retyped into Excel. Receipts go missing and totals don't match.
- Rent collected for landlords sits in a trust account mixed with deposits. Few agencies can say at any moment how much of it belongs to each landlord.
- Moving the agency's commission and management fees out of the trust account is calculated by hand each month.
- Landlord statements, tenant statements and agent commission statements are built manually, so they are late and disputed.
- Sales commissions and co-listing splits are tracked outside the system that records the deal.
- Directors cannot see agency income, money owed and money held without asking accounts.

> **v1 is successful when** an agency can answer three questions instantly, without Excel: how much do we hold for each landlord, how much has the agency earned this month, and who owes us money.

02 Scope

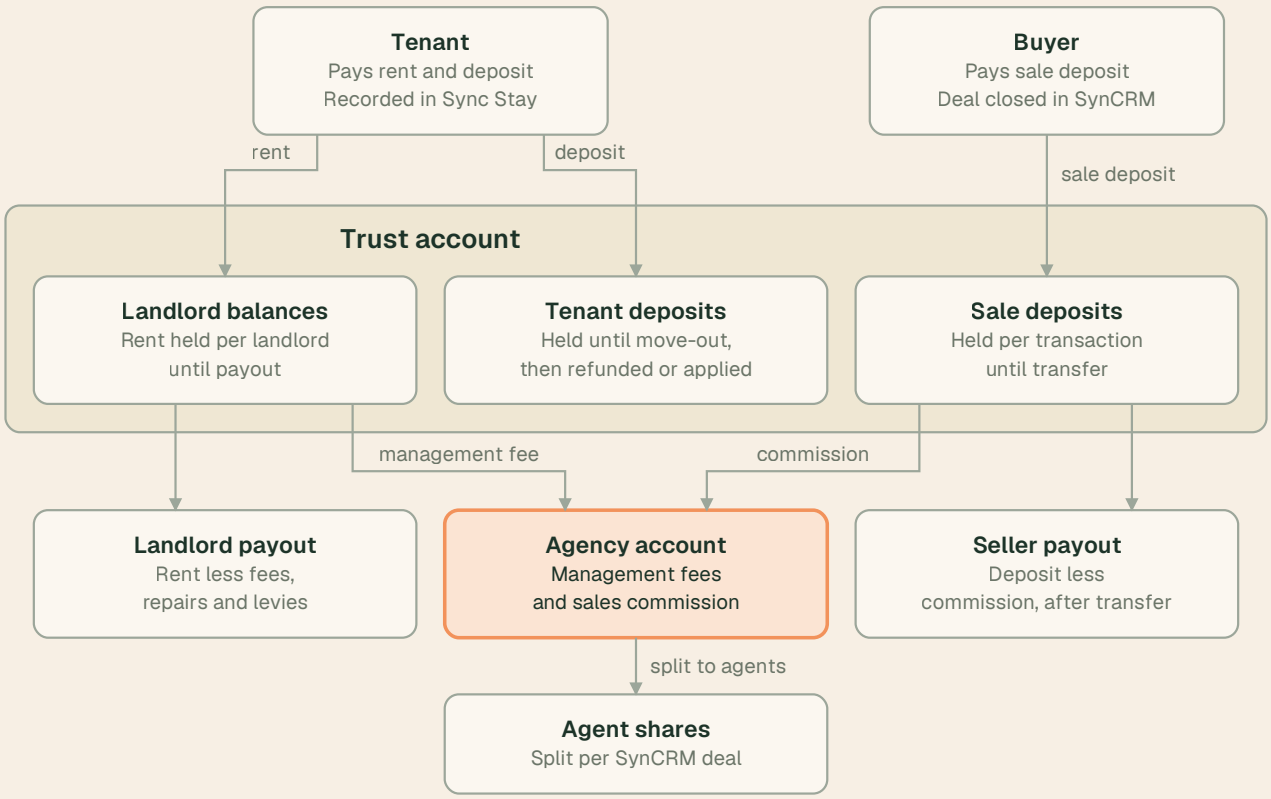
v1 covers the money specific to real estate agencies: client money in trust, landlord payouts, agency fees and commissions, and the agency's basic income and expenses. It is not a full accounting package.

In v1	Not in v1
Receipts for all money in (rent, deposits, stand instalments, sales deposits, fees)	Full double-entry general ledger, balance sheet, trial balance
Trust account ledger per landlord and per tenant deposit	Payroll and PAYE
Management fee and commission calculated and moved to agency income	VAT/tax returns (VAT shown on invoices only)
Landlord payouts recorded, with remittance advice	Bank feeds and automatic bank reconciliation
Sales commission from SynCRM deals, with agent splits	Online payments and payment gateways
Stand sale instalments and buyer accounts, linked to Sync Dev	Interest and penalties on late stand instalments
Invoices to landlords, buyers and other clients	Budgeting and forecasting
Agency expenses (simple categories)	Multi-company consolidation
Statements: landlord, tenant, stand buyer, developer, agent commission, client account	Live two-way sync with QuickBooks/Pastel (export only in v1)
Monthly agency income and expense report	Title transfer and conveyancing workflows
Exports for the agency's accountant and auditor	

Position against existing software: for agencies with nothing (receipt books and Excel), Sync Finance is their finance system. For agencies already on QuickBooks or Pastel, it handles the real estate side and exports to their accountant's package.

03 How money flows

Client money stays in trust until it is paid out or earned as a fee



MONEY FLOW · TRUST ACCOUNT TO PAYOUTS AND AGENCY INCOME

Rent and sale deposits land in trust first; tenant deposits do too where the agency holds them there (a setting). The agency only earns its commission when it is moved out of trust, either as each payment is received or in a month-end batch, and every movement shows on the matching statement or remittance advice.

Stand instalments from Sync Dev follow the same pattern: into trust when the agency sells for a developer (commission out, balance paid to the developer), or straight into the developer's business account when the developer is our client (see 5.10).

04 Users and access

Finance data is restricted by default. In many agencies the principal runs the finance side day to day, with no bookkeeper, so v1 must work for one non-accountant user as well as for a firm with an accounts clerk.

User	Access to Sync Finance
Principal / director	Everything, including approving transfers and payouts. Often the only finance user
Accounts / bookkeeper (if any)	Receipts, invoices, expenses, trust ledger, payouts (prepare), statements, exports
Property manager	Record receipts for their tenants; view their landlords' statements and balances
Sales agent	View their own commission statement only

> **Landlords, tenants and stand buyers never log in to Sync Finance.** Sync Finance produces their statements, receipts, invoices and remittance advices; they see them in two ways:
>
> - **Email:** every document is emailed as a PDF when it is created. This is enough on its own.
> - **Portals:** landlords and tenants also see their documents in the landlord and tenant portals, which belong to Sync Stay. The portals only display what Sync Finance has produced, read-only. A stand-buyer portal can follow later with Sync Dev; in v1, buyers get their statements by email.

Rules

- **Approval is a setting.** One approver (default): the principal records and approves transfers and payouts. Two approvers: one person prepares, a director approves. Every approval is logged either way.
- **Plain language.** Screens use "money in", "money out" and "balance", never debits and credits.
- Nothing financial is deleted. Mistakes are corrected with a reversal that shows who did it and why.

05 Functional requirements

"Must" items are required for v1 to launch. "Should" items go in v1 if time allows, otherwise v1.1. Where agencies work differently, v1 offers a setting rather than one fixed way; the default is how iProperties works today (see section 10).

5.1 Accounts set-up and settings

ID	Requirement	Priority
FN-01	Set up the agency's bank accounts and cash float, each marked as Trust, Business or Cash, with currency (USD or ZiG)	Must
FN-02	Opening balances per landlord, per tenant deposit and per account, imported from Excel at go-live	Must
FN-03	Simple income and expense categories, editable by the agency (e.g. management commission, lease admin fees, sales commission, salaries, fuel, advertising)	Must
FN-04	Agency details for documents: name, logo, address, VAT number (optional), bank details	Must
FN-05	Agency settings: when commission moves out of trust (on each receipt, or batched at month end); when landlords are paid (as rent is received, or monthly); where tenant deposits are held (trust, business account, or paid to the landlord); VAT on or off (off by default); one or two approvers	Must

5.2 Receipting (money in)

ID	Requirement	Priority
FN-10	Every receipt recorded in Sync Stay (rent, deposits, fees) posts automatically to the correct ledger	Must
FN-11	Record other money in directly: sales deposits, lease admin fees, fees from clients, other income, with the account or cash float it landed in	Must
FN-12	One receipt numbering sequence per agency across all modules; receipt printable on the spot and emailed	Must
FN-13	Reverse a receipt with a reason; the original stays visible	Must
FN-14	Cash handling: daily cash-up per person (cash received, banked, on hand), and recording cash deposited into the bank	Must

5.3 Trust account ledger

ID	Requirement	Priority
FN-20	Running balance per landlord (rent held for them) inside the trust account	Must
FN-21	Running balance per tenant deposit, wherever the deposit is held (per FN-05)	Must
FN-22	Running balance per sales transaction, if sale deposits pass through trust	Should
FN-23	Trust summary at any time: total held, split by landlord, deposits and sales	Must
FN-24	Block any payment from trust that would take a landlord's or transaction's balance below zero	Must
FN-25	Monthly trust reconciliation: system balance vs bank balance entered by the user, difference shown	Should

5.4 Fees and commission

ID	Requirement	Priority
FN-30	Management commission % set per landlord, with an override per property or lease (rates differ by landlord)	Must
FN-31	Commission calculated on each rent receipt and moved to agency income: immediately on receipt (default) or in a month-end batch, per FN-05	Must
FN-32	Lease admin fee: a fixed or % fee charged at lease signing or renewal, to the tenant or landlord, recorded as agency income	Must
FN-33	On a completed sale, take commission from the deal in SynCRM and record it as agency income	Must
FN-34	VAT added to fees only when the agency has VAT switched on	Should

5.5 Landlord payouts and expenses on their behalf

ID	Requirement	Priority
FN-40	Record expenses paid from trust on a landlord's behalf (repairs, rates, levies), reducing their balance	Must
FN-41	Pay a landlord as rent is received (default): after a receipt, show the amount payable (rent less commission and expenses) and record the payout with method and reference	Must
FN-42	Monthly payout run for agencies that pay landlords once a month	Should
FN-43	Each payout generates a remittance advice (PDF, emailed) showing what was collected, deducted and paid	Must
FN-44	Pay out a seller's balance on a completed sale the same way	Should

5.6 Sales commissions and agent splits

ID	Requirement	Priority
FN-50	Take each closed deal's commission and agent split percentages from SynCRM (no retyping)	Must
FN-51	Calculate each agent's share; record when it is paid to the agent	Must

5.7 Invoices

ID	Requirement	Priority
FN-60	Create an invoice on request to a landlord, buyer, seller or other client, with line items and currency	Must
FN-61	Rent invoices generated by Sync Stay appear here alongside all other invoices	Must
FN-62	Record payments against invoices; show unpaid invoices with age	Must
FN-63	Generate a commission invoice from a SynCRM deal in one click	Should

5.8 Agency expenses (money out of the business account)

ID	Requirement	Priority
FN-70	Record the agency's own payments: date, category, amount, account or cash, supplier, photo of the slip	Must
FN-71	Monthly money in vs money out report for the agency, by category	Must

5.9 Exports and year-end

ID	Requirement	Priority
FN-80	Export receipts, payments, fees, payouts, invoices and expenses by date range to Excel	Must
FN-81	Year-end auditor pack: receipts and payments schedule for the financial year, and transactions per bank account, in one export	Must
FN-82	Export in a format QuickBooks and Pastel can import	Should

5.10 Stand sales on payment plans (with Sync Dev)

Sync Dev holds the developments, stands, buyers and each buyer's payment plan. Sync Finance handles the money: it receipts each instalment against the buyer's stand account and produces the statements. Two set-ups exist, chosen per development:

- **Developer is our client:** buyer payments go straight to the developer's business account; it is their own income.
- **Agency sells for a developer:** buyer payments go into the agency's trust account; the agency takes its commission and pays the rest to the developer, the same way it pays landlords.

ID	Requirement	Priority
FN-90	Receipt a stand payment (deposit or instalment) against the buyer's stand account, cash or transfer, with a printed and emailed receipt	Must
FN-91	Allocate each payment to the oldest instalment due; recalculate paid to date, balance, amount overdue and next due date, and send these back to Sync Dev	Must
FN-92	Set per development who holds the money: developer's business account, or the agency's trust account	Must
FN-93	Agency selling for a developer: commission per development (on each instalment, or once the stand is fully paid); developer payouts with remittance advice	Must
FN-94	Buyer statement: stand, price, deposit, every instalment paid, balance, overdue amount, next due date	Must
FN-95	Email buyers an instalment reminder before each due date, and an overdue notice after it	Must
FN-96	Developer report per development: stands sold, total contracted, collected to date, outstanding, overdue by buyer	Must
FN-97	Buyer switches stand or cancels: move or refund what they have paid, with a record	Should

Interest and penalties on late instalments, and title transfer, are not in v1.

06 Statements and reports

Statements are what clients see, so they must be correct, branded and generated in one click. All export to PDF; reports also export to Excel.

Statements

Statement	For	Shows
Remittance advice	Landlord or developer, with each payout	Amount received, commission and expenses deducted, amount paid, method and reference
Landlord statement	Landlord (monthly, emailed + portal)	Per property: rent charged, received, arrears, commission, expenses, payouts made, balance held
Tenant statement	Tenant (emailed + portal)	Invoices, payments, balance, deposit held
Stand buyer statement	Stand buyer (emailed)	Stand, price, deposit, instalments paid, balance, amount overdue, next due date
Developer statement	Developer (monthly, emailed)	Per development: stands sold, collected, commission, paid out, still outstanding
Agent commission statement	Sales agent	Deals closed, commission earned, their split, paid and unpaid
Client account statement	Buyer, seller or other client	Invoices, payments, balance

Bulk send: generate and email all monthly landlord statements in one action, with a preview first.

Finance dashboard (in the Hub)

Opens on the three numbers principals asked for, for this week or this month, per account: **money in (receipts), money out (payments) and balance.** Below them: money held in trust, commission earned, landlord payouts due, unpaid invoices and tenant arrears.

Reports

- **Receipts and payments schedule:** every receipt and payment by period, category and account. This is the report auditors ask for.
- **Cash book:** transactions per bank account and cash float, with running balance.
- **Trust report:** balance per landlord, deposits held, sale deposits held, total.
- **Agency income and expense report:** by month and category.
- **Debtors:** unpaid invoices and tenant arrears by age.
- **Commission report:** by agent and by month.
- **Stand sales report:** per development, collected this month, outstanding, and every buyer who is overdue.

07 Data and integrations

Sync Finance owns the money records; SynCRM, Sync Stay and Sync Dev feed it automatically so nothing is typed twice.

Key records (Andre and Tino design the schema)

Record	Key fields
Bank account	Name, type (Trust/Business), currency, opening balance
Transaction	Date, account, direction (in/out), amount, currency, category, linked landlord/tenant/deal/invoice, reference, reversed flag, created by
Ledger entry	Transaction, ledger (landlord, deposit, sale, stand buyer, developer, agency income), amount
Invoice	Number, client, lines, VAT, currency, due date, status
Payout	Landlord or seller, period, amount, status (prepared, approved, paid), bank reference, approved by
Commission	Deal, total, agent splits, status per agent

Integrations

Connects to	Direction	What flows
Sync Stay	Stay → Finance	Receipts, deposits, charges, maintenance costs, commission rates
Sync Stay	Finance → Stay	Statements, invoices, receipts and payout history, displayed read-only in the landlord and tenant portals
Sync Dev	Dev → Finance	Developments, stands, buyers, sale price, payment plans and due dates, who holds the money
Sync Dev	Finance → Dev	Payments received, paid to date, balance, amount overdue and next due date, shown against each stand
SynCRM	CRM → Finance	Closed deals: sale price, commission, agent splits, buyer and seller
Hub	Both	Login and roles, shared contacts and properties, notifications, finance dashboard figures
QuickBooks / Pastel	Finance → accounting	File export in v1; live sync is a later paid add-on

08 Non-functional requirements and acceptance

Non-functional

- **Cash first:** recording a cash payment and printing its receipt takes under a minute, on a phone or a desktop.
- **Accuracy:** every balance is calculated from transactions, never typed in. Statements, reports and the dashboard always agree.
- **Audit trail:** who created, approved or reversed every transaction, and when. No hard deletes.
- **Currency:** every amount carries its currency; USD and ZiG kept separate. No automatic conversion in v1.

- **Access:** finance data restricted by role on the server; approvals per the agency's setting.
- **Period lock:** once a month is closed, its transactions cannot be changed, only reversed in the current month.
- **Documents:** receipts, invoices, remittance advices and statements carry the agency's branding and print cleanly on A4.
- **Multi-tenant, mobile-friendly, daily backups:** same standard as the rest of Sync Estate.

v1 is accepted when an agency can do all of this without Excel or a receipt book

- [ ] Import opening balances for each landlord, deposit and account
- [ ] Email tenants a rent invoice before the due date
- [ ] Receipt a cash payment, print the receipt, and see it in the right landlord's balance
- [ ] Move commission to agency income as each payment is received, using that landlord's rate
- [ ] Pay the landlord and email a remittance advice
- [ ] Charge a lease admin fee at signing
- [ ] See money in, money out and balance for the week or month on the dashboard
- [ ] Produce the year-end receipts and payments schedule for the auditor
- [ ] Receipt a stand instalment and send the buyer an updated statement, with the balance shown against the stand in Sync Dev

09 Open questions

For Andre and Tino

- [ ] Ledger design: a simple double-entry engine underneath (recommended, keeps balances honest) even though users never see debits and credits?
- [ ] Use an open-source accounting engine, or build the ledger ourselves?
- [ ] Realistic build estimate for the Must items, and which Should items fit

Still to confirm with clients

- [ ] Do they take payments in ZiG, or USD only?
- [ ] Do sale deposits pass through trust, and how are commissions split with agents?
- [ ] Lease admin fee: fixed amount or %, and paid by the tenant or the landlord?
- [ ] Fiscalisation: do any target clients need ZIMRA-fiscalised receipts or invoices?
- [ ] Are there Estate Agents Council trust-account rules we must match?
- [ ] Receipt book, Excel and landlord statement samples from iProperties (promised); use them to set the layout of our receipts and statements
- [ ] Stand sales: is our first client a developer selling its own stands, or an agency selling for a developer? (decides whether v1 needs the trust set-up in 5.10)
- [ ] Stand sales: how is agency commission earned: on each instalment, or once the stand is fully paid?

> **Note:** this BRD makes Sync Finance a real estate finance system in its own right, not just an accounting integration. Client-facing material describing it as integration-only needs updating.

10 Discovery input: iProperties (Oct 2026)

One agency's answers. Where they may differ from other agencies, v1 makes them a setting and uses iProperties' way as the default.

Question	iProperties' answer	What it changed
How tenants pay	Mostly cash, sometimes bank transfer	Cash-first receipting and daily cash-up (FN-14)
Invoice before rent is due?	Would be ideal	Rent invoices before the due date (Sync Stay, FN-61)
Commission rate and other fees	Not fixed; lease admin fees too	Rate per landlord with overrides (FN-30); lease admin fee (FN-32)
When commission leaves trust	As and when payment is received	Move on each receipt by default (FN-05, FN-31)
Expenses paid from trust	Sometimes	Kept (FN-40)
When landlords are paid	As and when rent is received	Pay per receipt by default, with remittance advice (FN-41, FN-43)
Deposits in trust?	Not usually	Deposit location is a setting (FN-05, FN-21)
Sales commission invoicing	Only on request	Invoices on request (FN-60); sale deposits through trust moved to Should (FN-22)
VAT	Not registered	VAT off by default (FN-05, FN-34)
Year-end	Auditor needs bank accounts and a receipts and payments schedule	Year-end auditor pack (FN-81) and schedule report
Top three numbers	Receipts, payments, balance	These lead the finance dashboard
Day-to-day user	The principal	Single-approver default, plain language (section 4)